DIMENSIONS OF CULTURE

From Geert Hofstede

High power distance: Lower-status members of society expect and accept that power is distributed unequally.

Low power distance: Lower-status members of society do not expect or accept it when power is distributed unequally.

High uncertainty avoidance: People are uncomfortable with uncertainty and ambiguity.

Low uncertainty avoidance: People are more tolerant of uncertainty and ambiguity.

Individualism: Preference for loose ties between individuals and society. Individuals take care of themselves and their immediate family.

Collectivism: Preference for a tightly-knit society. Individuals are loyal to their extended families and other ingroups.

Masculinity: Society values competition, big achievements, assertiveness, and material success.

Femininity: Society is driven by cooperation, consensus, and improving overall quality of life for all members.

(Long term) Pragmatic orientation: Focuses on adaptability and improving the future, especially through education and thrift.

(Short term) Normative orientation: Focuses on the past and present and is marked by an adherence to traditions and norms. Societal change is not welcome.

Indulgence: Values fun and the gratification of human desires.

Restraint: Features strict social norms to control the gratification of human desires.

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From Erin Meyer

Consensus-based decision-making: Decisions are made only when everyone is in agreement.	**Top-down decision-making:** Everyone is expected to support the leadership's decision, regardless of their opinion.
decisions (with a little d): Made quickly but subject to continued adaptation.	**Decisions (with a big D):** Painstakingly planned but final.
Applications-first: This type of thinker wants the actionable information before the facts. They're more interested in *how* things work than *why*.	**Principles-first:** This type of thinker wants to hear the methodology before the idea. They prefer establishing a general theory, then applying it to the specific situation.
Specific thinking: The belief that you can analyze something by separating it from its environment.	**Holistic thinking:** Analysis of any object or problem must consider its many connections to the broader environment.
Relationship-based trust: Personal relationships are at the core of business relationships.	**Task-based trust:** People place their faith in those who demonstrate professional competence and efficiency, regardless of whether they have a social relationship.
Confrontational cultures get right to the point when giving feedback or offering critique and may use "upgraders" like *very* or *extremely*.	**Nonconfrontational** cultures often sandwich criticism with agreement or praise. They may use "downgraders" like *somewhat* or *a little*.

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From Edward Hall

Monochronic: Time is viewed in absolute terms, and people focus on one task at a time.	**Polychronic:** Time is seen in flexible, relative terms, and people may engage in several tasks at once.
Low-context communication: A person's meaning is contained directly in his or her words.	**High-context communication:** Much of what a person means is conveyed without words.
Low territoriality: Little interest in boundaries and territory. Members of this culture share easily. (Frequently correlated with high-context cultures.)	**High territoriality:** A great concern for boundaries and ownership. (Frequently correlated with low-context cultures.)

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